Welcome to Buinho app – how to install and use it

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The Welcome to Buinho app is your pocket guide to the residency: open buinho-creative-hub.github.io/welcome-buinho on your phone, ideally in Google Chrome. It is free, needs no account and works in English and Portuguese.

Why use it

Everything you need for your stay is in one place, and it is faster than scrolling back through WhatsApp.

- **Start here:** the Buinho AIR WhatsApp group, how to get here and what to do when you arrive.
- **Guide:** short answers about your house, Buinho, the FabLab and Messejana — Wi-Fi, rubbish days, shops, buses, where to eat.
- **Assistant:** ask a practical question in any language and get an answer straight away, day or night.
- **FabLab:** what each machine does and the rules. To use a machine, arrange it with the team.
- **Your week:** what's on at Buinho in the coming days, updated by the team.
- **Map:** the houses, shops, café, pharmacy, ATM and pool, with directions.
- **Talk to the team:** tell us you've arrived, report a problem in the house, ask something or leave feedback. It reaches the team directly — no email needed.
- **Works offline:** once opened, the guide, map and contacts stay on your phone. The assistant, agenda updates and messages need internet.

Option 1: just open the link

No install needed — this works on any phone, tablet or laptop.

1. Open **Google Chrome**.
2. Go to buinho-creative-hub.github.io/welcome-buinho.
3. Bookmark the page so you can find it again.
4. Pick **EN** or **PT** at the top right.

If you got the link in WhatsApp, tap it and choose **Open in Chrome** rather than staying in WhatsApp's own browser.

Option 2: install it on Android

Installing puts a Buinho icon on your home screen. The app then opens full screen, like any other app, and works offline. It takes no space worth mentioning and you can remove it at any time.

1. Open the link in **Google Chrome**.
2. Tap the ⋮ menu (top right).
3. Tap **Install app** or **Add to Home screen**, then **Install**.
4. Find the blue Buinho icon on your home screen or in your app list.

Sometimes Chrome shows an **Install** banner at the bottom of the page — tapping it does the same.

Option 2: install it on iPhone

The result is the same as on Android: a Buinho icon on your home screen that opens the app full screen.

1. Open the link in **Chrome** (or Safari).
2. Tap the **Share** button — in Chrome it is at the top right of the address bar; in Safari it is the square with an arrow at the bottom.
3. Scroll down and tap **Add to Home Screen**.
4. Tap **Add**. The blue Buinho icon appears on your home screen.

In Chrome this needs iOS 16.4 or later. If you don't see **Add to Home Screen** there, use Safari for this step.

Using the app

The bar at the bottom has three buttons; everything else is in the numbered index on the home screen.

Where	What it's for
Index (bottom bar)	Home screen: Wi-Fi, address, emergency number and the index
Map (bottom bar)	Places in Messejana. Tap a place, then **Go** for directions; the location button shows where you are

Where	What it's for
Assistant (bottom bar)	Type a question in any language, e.g. “where can I buy bread?”. If it can't help, it points you to the team
01 Start here	WhatsApp group, getting here, arriving
02 Guide	Questions and answers about the house, Buinho and Messejana, then the places on the map
03 FabLab	Machines and rules; to use a machine, talk to the team
04 Your week	The agenda for the coming days
05 Contacts & safety	112 and the team's phone numbers
06 Talk to the team	Arrived, a problem in the house, a question or feedback

A good habit: when something isn't clear, ask the Assistant first. If it is something only the team can solve — a broken boiler, a key, a special arrangement — use **Talk to the team**. In an emergency, call **112** first.

Your data

The app collects almost nothing about you, and nothing without you choosing to send it.

- **No account, no login, no password.** You don't sign up for anything.
- **No ads, no tracking, no analytics.** We don't follow what you read or where you tap.
- **Your name and house** are remembered only on your own phone, so you don't retype them. They reach the team only when you press **Send** in “Talk to the team”.

- **What you send to the team** goes to a private Buinho spreadsheet and the team's chat. Only the Buinho team sees it, and it is used only to help you during your stay.
- **Questions to the Assistant** are answered by an AI model (Claude, by Anthropic). They are not linked to your name. Your phone sends a random code, used only to limit how many questions can be asked per day. Please don't put personal details in your questions.
- **Your location** is used only on your phone, to show where you are on the map. It is never sent to us.
- **The map** uses OpenStreetMap, which sees an ordinary web request, like any website.

To erase everything the app keeps on your phone, remove the app or clear the site's data in your browser settings.

Troubleshooting

Most problems are solved by using Google Chrome and reloading the app. If that doesn't work, find your problem below.

Problem	What to do
Something looks broken or old (the map is grey, or shows an "API key" message)	Your phone is showing an old saved copy. Close the app or tab completely and open it again. Still wrong? In Chrome: ⋮ → **Settings** → **Site settings** → **All sites**, find the app's site, then **Clear & reset**, and open the link again
It works badly in another browser (Samsung Internet, Firefox, WhatsApp's built-in browser…)	Open the link in **Google Chrome**. It is the browser we test the app on
No **Install** / **Add to Home screen** option	Android: make sure you are in Chrome, not inside WhatsApp or Instagram. iPhone: use the **Share** button; if Chrome doesn't offer it, use Safari
"Where am I" on the map doesn't work	Allow location for the site: in Chrome, tap the icon left of the address, then **Permissions** → **Location** → **Allow**. Also check the phone's location is on
The Assistant says it can't answer right now	You may be offline, or the daily question limit was reached. Try later, or use **Talk to the team**
A message to the team doesn't send	The app offers to send it by WhatsApp instead. You can also write in the Buinho AIR WhatsApp group
The app icon didn't change after an update	Remove the app from your home screen and add it again
Still stuck	Ask anyone from the team at the FabLab, or write in the WhatsApp group

A quick test: if the app looks wrong in a normal Chrome tab but fine in an **Incognito** tab, it is an old saved copy — clear the site's data as described in the first row.